

What is an animal?

A key definition of an animal, as opposed to a plant, is that most animals can move voluntarily. Animals must also eat other living things to survive. Let's take a look at some of the things animals do.

Bald eagle

Food is fuel

All animals have to find and eat food to survive. Carnivores are animals that eat meat. Herbivores eat mainly plants. Omnivores are creatures that eat both plants and meat.



Squirrels eat seeds, nuts, fruits, and fungi.

Getting around

Many animals have muscles, which allow them to move in a variety of ways.



Birds **fly** by flapping wings or gliding on currents of hot air.



Animals like fish **swim** by moving their bodies and fins.



Some snakes **wriggle**; others raise and flatten their bodies.



Many animals **walk** and **run** using their legs.



Sea anemones **reach out** their tentacles to sting prey.

What nerve!

Animals have nerves, which carry information from their sense organs.

Most animals have brains to monitor this information.

The nerves also carry orders from the brain to the organs and muscles—such as instructions to stay still, attack, or run away!

